

Yana Veitsman

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Education

Universität Göttingen

PHD COMPUTER SCIENCE

- Topic: Cognitively Plausible Strategies for Sample-Efficient Modeling

Göttingen, Germany

Dec 2025 - now

Universität des Saarlandes

MSC LANGUAGE SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY: CGPA 1.4/1.0

- MSc Thesis: Why Does Better Cross-Lingual Alignment Fail for Better Cross-Lingual Transfer?

Saarbrücken, Germany

Oct 2023 – Oct 2025

American University in Bulgaria (AUBG)

BA COMPUTER SCIENCE: SUMMA CUM LAUDE, CGPA: 3.93/4.0

- BA Thesis: NLP-based Social Media Post Generator
- Erasmus+ Exchange: Universitat de València
- Minors: Mathematics, Modern Languages & Cultures (Spanish language focus)

Blagoevgrad, Bulgaria

Jan 2019 – Dec 2022

Research Experience

Universität Göttingen, Human-Centered Data Science Lab

ADVISOR: PROF. DR. LISA BEINBORN

- Investigating inductive biases for sample-efficient multilingual learning

Göttingen, Germany

Dec 2025 - now

Universität des Saarlandes, Language Science and Technology Dept

ADVISORS: PROF. DR. MICHAEL HAHN, PROF. DR. VERA DEMBERG

- Defining persistent theoretical limitations in pre-trained language models
- Identifying mechanisms behind in-context learning capabilities
- Developing a framework for understanding expressive capacity of state space models

Saarbrücken, Germany

Feb 2024 - Aug 2025

German Research Center for Artificial Intelligence (DFKI)

ADVISORS: DR. SIMON OSTERMANN, CENNET OGUZ

- Annotating and validating datasets for multimodal anaphora resolution

Saarbrücken, Germany

Feb 2024 - Oct 2024

Publications

Y. Veitsman*, J. Mayer Martins*, J. Lautenschlager, L. Beinborn. 2026. Structural Priors for Data-Efficient Language Learning. Proceedings of the 4th BabyLM Workshop, co-located with EMNLP.

Y. Veitsman, Y. Liu, H. Schütze. 2026. Why Better Cross-Lingual Alignment Fails for Better Cross-Lingual Transfer: Case of Encoders. Proceedings of the 6th Workshop on Multilingual Representation Learning (MRL), co-located with EMNLP.

M. Jobanputra*, **Y. Veitsman***, Y. Sarrof, A. Bakalova, V. Demberg, E. Pavlick, M. Hahn. 2025. Born a Transformer – Always a Transformer? Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS).

A. Bakalova, **Y. Veitsman**, X. Huang, M. Hahn. 2025. Contextualize-then-Aggregate: Circuits for In-Context Learning in Gemma-2 2B. Conference on Language Modeling (COLM).

Y. Veitsman, M. Hartmann. 2025. Recent Advancements and Challenges of Turkic Central Asian Language Processing. Proceedings of the First Workshop on Language Models for Low-Resource Languages (LoResLM), co-located with COLING.

Y. Sarrof, **Y. Veitsman**, M. Hahn. 2024. The Expressive Capacity of State Space Models: A Formal Language Perspective. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS).

* Equal contribution.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2024	Professional Development Grant , American Councils for International Education	\$250
2023	Outstanding Achievement in Computer Science , AUBG	
2023	Outstanding Achievement in Modern Languages & Cultures , AUBG	

Presentations

** equal contribution*

CONTRIBUTED PRESENTATIONS

- Y. Veitsman**, Y. Liu, and H. Schütze. Mar 2026. *Why Better Cross-Lingual Alignment Fails for Better Cross-Lingual Transfer*. Poster at HumanCLAIM Workshop, Göttingen, Germany.
- Y. Veitsman**, Y. Liu, and H. Schütze. Mar 2026. *Why Better Cross-Lingual Alignment Fails for Better Cross-Lingual Transfer*. The 10th Göttingen-Hildesheim Workshop for Computational Linguistics and Digital Humanities, Hildesheim, Germany.
- Y. Sarrof, **Y. Veitsman**, and M. Hahn. Dec 2025. *The Expressive Capacity of State Space Models: A Formal Language Perspective*. Markov Lab Seminar, St.Petersburg State University, online.
- Y. Veitsman** and M. Hartmann. Jan 2025. *The Expressive Capacity of State Space Models: A Formal Language Perspective*. Poster at LoResLM Workshop, COLING, Abu Dhabi, UAE.
- Y. Sarrof, **Y. Veitsman**, and M. Hahn. Dec 2024. *The Expressive Capacity of State Space Models: A Formal Language Perspective*. Poster at NeurIPS, Vancouver, Canada.
- M. Rofin*, Y. Sarrof*, and **Y. Veitsman***. May 2024. *Transformers or RNNs or SSMS: Who's More Sensitive?* TaCoS, The 33rd Computational Linguistics Student Conference, Saarbrücken, Germany.
- Y. Veitsman**. Apr 2022. *Comparing Modeling of Russian and English Languages from the Point of View of NLP Potential*. The 17th Fellowship of the Mind Student Conference, AUBG, Blagoevgrad, Bulgaria.

Teaching Experience

2026	Interpretability and Bias in Machine Learning , Substitute Teaching Assistant	Universität Göttingen
2020	Introduction to Programming in C++ , Subject Tutor	AUBG

Mentoring

2026 – now	Martina Juhárová , Master Student	Universität Göttingen
2026	Merle Hellwig , Master Student	Universität Göttingen
2026	Jonathan Lautenschlager , Master Student	Universität Göttingen

Outreach & Professional Development

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2026 – now	BabyLM Workshop , Organizer	
2026 – now	Gesellschaft für wissenschaftliche Datenverarbeitung mbH Göttingen , Computing Cluster Group Ambassador	Universität Göttingen
2025	LangLunches – informal research talks , Organizer	Universität des Saarlandes
2024 – 2025	ELLIS Pre-NeurIPS Session , Organizer	Universität des Saarlandes

INFORMAL TALKS AND OUTREACH

- Apr 2026. *Interpretability and Bias in Language Models*. AI Teaching Days, with Jonas Mayer Martins, Göttingen, Germany.
- Mar 2026. *Is Your LLM Really a Polyglot?* Pint of Science Festival, Göttingen, Germany.
- May 2025. *LLM Prompting Strategies for Everyone*. IT-Hub Terricon Valley, Karagandy, Kazakhstan.

May 2023. *Introduction to Natural Language Processing*. IT-Hub Terricon Valley, Karagandy, Kazakhstan.

PEER REVIEW

Emergency Reviewer, LREC 2026

Secondary Reviewer, COLM 2026

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

The 2nd Athens Natural Language Processing School. Sep 2024. Athens, Greece.